

On the Behavior of Light

A private study, recorded at the harbor bench

For the tides, which keep no one's time but their own.

On reflection, first that:

The geometry of light on moving water is not an easy subject, and it deserves an honest introduction. Every reflection below was observed from the same bench at the same hour, and each was drawn as it appeared, without embellishment. What looks like a simple pattern of ripples is, on close reading, a family of curves. The eye learns to separate the wave that carries a line of light from the wave that merely carries the shadow of the next.

A quotation in a monospaced face, set apart from the body

"Detail is the friend of the patient observer. Begin
with one line, own that line, and only then allow
yourself the next."

The quoted material uses a different font family, a different size, and generous indentation from both margins, so the reconstruction must hold it apart while keeping the surrounding paragraph text in order.

SET IN SMALL CAPS, A LINE OF EMPHASIS

The lines that follow use an unusually large leading for their size, placing each line far from its neighbors. The generous spacing stresses the layout code's tolerance for documents that do not follow a tight grid.

A second paragraph continues the thought, and a third line completes the page, so there is enough text to reconstruct regardless of the unusual spacing above.

An italic closing reflection

Italic body text is uncommon in fiction but entirely legal in a PDF, and it changes the flags and family names the layout code sees. The converter should preserve the words as body text.